POL-07 Deploy policy

Freeze window

No deploys to payments services from Friday 16:00 UTC to Monday 08:00 UTC, and none during a declared incident unless the deploy is the fix.

Emergency deploys

An emergency deploy in the freeze needs approval from the incident commander and a second engineer, both posted in #deploy-approvals before the deploy starts.

Canary

Every deploy goes to a 5% canary for 30 minutes. Promote only if the canary error rate is no higher than the stable pods.

Feature flags

Turning a flag on for all merchants counts as a deploy and follows the freeze. Turning a flag off to stop harm never needs approval.

Database migrations

A migration that rewrites a table runs on its own deploy, never with code that depends on it, and never in the freeze.